

CSS Committee Meeting - Minutes

Location:	Hybrid
Date:	Tuesday 29th September
Time:	17:00 BST
Attendees:	Joe Adams (JA) (Chair), Henry Thomas (HT) (Minuting), Idris Evans (IE), Albert Waldron (AW), Anna Charleton (AC), George Tong (GT), Tyler King (TK), Day Jones (DJ)

- 1 Apologies JA
 - Harry
 - Jacob
- 2 Adoption of Previous Minutes HT
- 3 Matters Arising All
 - **T-shirts**
 - Ordered and on the way - 10 business days
 - Set up t-shirt publicity and do a small t-shirt collecting event to encourage memberships
 - **Fresher's Week**
 - **Fresher's stand schedule**
 - **Action GT:** Make announcement to go out with the calendar
 - **Action completed**
 - **Annual RA**
 - Nearly 3 weeks with no reply
 - **Action HT:** Chase Annual RA
 - **Use of generative AI**
 - To be brought up in manifesto channels for EGM
 - **Contacting pizza companies**
 - **Action EW:** Contact pizza companies
 - **Action in progress**
- 4 Committee Handover All

- **Fresher's Week**

- **Board games night**

- Went well
- Had perfect amount of pizza, all the drinks went (except a small amount of guinness)

- **Societies night**

- Went pretty well, had about 80 people
- Because we ordered pizza early, didn't have enough, and had to order more
- Most people who didn't get pizza stayed for the later batch
- Lots of other societies thanked us for running the event
- AW suggests giving pizza tokens out up to the time we order the pizza to ensure that doesn't happen again and people aren't coming just for the pizza.
- Then any left over pizza would be handed out to people without tokens.

- **Fresher's Quiz**

- Very well received, about 13 teams instead of the predicted 5.
- Went really well, no issues.

- **Scavenger Hunt**

- **Action HW:** Print out QR code to the form and make a short announcement to go out on the Wednesday for it.
 - **Action completed**
- Went really well, a lot of people did it, somewhere around 30 or 40.
- A lot more than the 3 last year.
- Better advertising this year.
- Starting the teams off at the same time with an in person event was a much better way to do it.

- **CSS Lunch**

- Went really well, went to Alfred Works instead of Ming Moon.
- Had about 20 attendees last year but about 40 this year.
- Was more expensive but it was nice.
- Had issues with people not having bought tickets, and with people walking in front of cars but it was alright.
- AW says Ming Moon started in 2014, so it was the first time we went somewhere different.
- TK says we should advertise the student discount more.

- HT asks about getting the deposit back.
- JA says it was never taken but would have been if we didn't reach the £100 spend, but we did so it shouldn't have been taken.
- **Other events**
 - Stands went well - lots of engagement from PGRs, PGTs, and international students that we don't normally get.
 - Lots of people meeting others through our events and discord/other social media platforms.
 - HT says there was lots of interest in educational workshops and other similar events. TK and AW suggest bringing back TeX talks and workshops.
 - Also the sponsorship events should be good for that.

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Future Events (*standing item*)

All

- **Week 1 Pub**
 - **Action EW:** Put pub night announcement out today
 - **Action completed**
 - **Action GT:** Book pub night from 19:00-22:00 with 4 tables.
 - **Action completed**
 - JA, TK, AW, IE, GT going to the pub
 - Running a walking train meeting 15 minutes before outside CS
 - JS asks to double check the booking after someone called last minute to delete the booking last year.
 - **Action GT:** Double check pub night booking is definitely confirmed.
- **CSS 5K run**
 - Practice run Thursday at 17:00.
 - Run around starting and ending at the CS building.
 - Up to the Vale along roads and then back along the canal.
 - Run happening on Tuesday 6th October.
 - Announcement has gone out, will do another 1 week reminder.
 - **Action TK:** One week reminder for 5K run
- **Park/Winterbourne**
 - AW suggests having this in the next couple of weeks as it is more accessible than the run.
 - JS suggests checking the undergrad timetable before booking the event.
 - Wednesday is the best day for it
 - Wednesday 14th October - The Vale 11:00
 - **Action TK:** Publicity out tomorrow for this
 - **Action JS:** Guild activity and RA for the park

- AW asks if we are going to bring anything
- AC says she will ask the football captain to bring the football back
- JS suggests bringing soft drinks.
- JA says we need to make clear in the publicity that all food brought needs to be in date and cooked to meet guild requirements.
- AW not to bring any out-of-date, raw chicken
- **Break**
 - Starting next week.
 - Thursday 15:00-17:00.
 - IE can go to most, but can't do next Thursday.
 - TK says he can go.
 - We also need to buy food and drink for it.
 - JA begs us not to put empty packets of biscuits back into the cupboard.
 - DJ says they might be able to borrow their sister's costco membership this weekend to get some drinks and snacks.
 - DJ asks what sort of snacks we want.
 - AC says we have a small amount of mini cheddars and digestives.
 - HT says we have a small amount of blackcurrant squash left over from board games.
 - Snacks and Drinks - bulk buy big boxes of multipack snacks:
 - Biscuits - Digestives, mini cheddars?
 - Crisps
 - Squash
 - HT and AW ask if Aldi own-brand would be cheaper than costco with membership.
 - DJ suggests that aldi might be better to save the fuel for the small cost difference.
 - JA suggests going with aldi this week to gauge interest before buying lots.
 - **Action IE:** Buy snacks and drinks from aldi
 - DJ says they could meet IE at Aldi to pick up the snacks/drinks and drive them to campus.
 - JA says we need a big announcement about break being started.
 - **Action TK:** Announcement for break before weekly roundup
 - **Action TK:** Weekly roundup announcements
 - HT asks if we need a guild activity for break
 - JA says he isn't sure but will check

- AW says for the pub last year it was one at the start and then it repeated from their
- HT says the RA is in the annual RA but that hasn't been approved yet
- **Action HT:** Make the guild activity for the fortnightly breaks
- **CSS Plush Making**
 - **Action AW:** Message Fearne to start planning it if possible
 - **Action completed**
 - JA asks if we should wait for next semester to try and get a grant for it
- **PUB**
 - IE, TK, and AW will try to be regular
 - Someone needs to turn up and book the tables
 - Normally the full back section is booked
 - TK says to see how this event goes before deciding on amount to book in future.
 - **Action JA:** Do guild activity for the pub nights
 - HT says the RA is also in the annual RA
 - **Action TK:** Announcement for pub
- **Outlines for major events**
 - **Halloween quiz**
 - 18:00 - 22:00, 29th October in CS
 - **Action HT:** Make quiz
 - **Action in progress**
 - **Action HT:** Guild activity, RA, catering form
 - **Action TK:** Publicity
 - **Action JA:** Contact the school for atrium and Todd to serve alcohol
 - Prizes from Ikea were suggested previously
 - DJ says they can drive to get the prizes from ikea if that is decided
 - JA suggests doing ducks for runner up
 - IE asks how many ducks we have
 - HT says loads
 - Two guest rounds being planned
 - HT will start making the quiz, and do 4 rounds, including picture round(s)
 - Committee needed to judge costume competition and do pizza
 - Staff team potentially coming
 - HT suggests getting cheaper alcohol from aldi and getting own brand stuff

- DJ also says they could collect the drinks from aldi car park
 - JA asks how much compared to board games night
 - HT says a similar amount to board games as we mostly ran out but it is likely to be slightly quieter.
 - Will need to get decorations out and put them up.
- **Ball**
 - **Action GT:** Look around for some options for hosting the ball
 - **Action pending**
 - HT posits booking Aston Webb as it might be cheaper for societies
 - JA says he thinks it is probably more expensive than other places
- **EGM**
 - 21st October, 13:00-15:00
 - G33 should be free
 - **Action JA:** Contact Todd to ask him to book the room for a couple of hours and make chair slides
 - **Action IE:** Treasurer slides
 - Will need to TeX cutout and voting stickers and banner
 - **Action JS:** Contact Matty to ask how to set up the voting website
 - **Action TK:** Publicity for both 1 and 2 week deadlines
 - **Action JA:** Channels for advertising
 - AW asks if we are having snacks and drinks there
 - JA says we can decide nearer the time
 - HT says if it's pre-packaged we don't need a catering form so we can decide on the day if needed
- **Christmas Meal**
 - **Action HT:** Email Green man to start process and let them know provisional time
 - **Action completed**
 - HT hasn't heard back so will follow up
 - **Action HT:** Follow up email to Green Man
- **Teasoc collab**
 - Week 7 or 8 potential
 - If week 8 could replace break 15:00-17:00
 - Usual collab with tea, scones, etc
- **Other events**
 - **Action ML:** Reach out to VGS to ask about an early collab
 - **Action transferred to JA and completed**

- **NQ64**
 - AW says he will go
 - DJ says it sounds fun
 - Week 9 suggested
 - Might have started at round 19:00
 - AW says we either advised uberbing or did a walking train
 - JA says we did a walking train there
 - Thursday 26th November, 19:00-22:00
- **Bot-a-thon**
 - DJ says they would like to run a mini hackathon for making discord bots
 - Might increase interest for birminghack if done over a weekend in semester 1
 - DJ happy to do guild paperwork but doesn't know enough about discord bots to run it
 - Teaching on Saturday
 - Hackathon bit on sunday
 - Saturday 21st, Sunday 22nd November?
 - JS might be able to help with this, he knows more about discord bots
 - Might do pizza but can decide nearer the time
 - TK says we did do pizza two years ago
- **Other hackathons**
 - DJ asks if we wants other hackathons
 - Says early semester two would be good as birminghack is probably in March
 - Something to keep in mind for future planning
 - HT says we had a lot of interest about hackathons so that would be a good thing to run
- **Bar Crawl**
 - AW & GT happy to look into bar crawl
 - HT says main t-shirt ordering issue was because it was over £1000 so shouldn't have the same problem with bar crawl t-shirt order
 - AW incredibly happy to test the route out (definitely will be there, he heard alcohol)
 - JA says it will be ticketed, with extra for t-shirts
 - Inverted colours for stewards
 - **Action AW & GT:** Look into bar crawl
- **Cheese soc collab**
 - GT spoke to cheese soc, no progress yet
 - Eating cheese and crackers

- Could run that soon
 - HT suggests inviting them to a break alongside the usual to make it a better event
 - Could do week 4 or week 6, week 6 is consolidation though
 - Week 4 would be a good week for it
 - **Action GT:** Reach out to cheese soc and see if they would like to do 15:00 - 17:00 on the Thursday of week 4
 - AW's puns: Camamb-reak, Break-otta, Brie-k, Gouda get to break
 - **Workshop**
 - Would need to find someone willing to run one for rust
 - Could do a python workshop
 - Week 8?
 - On hold for a week
 - **Action JA:** Contact Matt about OSM Mapathon
- 7 Sponsor/Industry Update (*standing item*) HT
- **Pipeline and active discussions**
- 8 Finance Report (*standing item*) IE
- **Most recent statement balance: £802.74**
 - **Actual working balance: about £2,000**
 - **Pending incomings**
 - **Capital One sponsorship**
 - **TPP sponsorship**
 - **Memberships**
 - **Pending outgoings**
 - **T-shirts**
 - **Server costs (on grant)**
 - Habiba has been emailed to put expenses from before the grant onto it retroactively, but no reply
 - **Pizza**
 - **Board games**
 - Awaiting the receipt
 - **Societies night**
 - JA needs to submit expense request
 - **Alcohol**
 - **Action JA:** Speak to Zoe to confirm how the alcohol is being paid for
 - **Football booking**
 - **Football football**
 - **Stickers**

- **Valyfy lost funds**
 - No reply from Habiba
- **Grants**
 - Got part of server costs grants requested, and nothing else
- **EPS Culture Fund**
 - Was used for Bletchley park last year, IE will look into

9 EDI Report (*standing item*) All

- **Black History Month**
 - **Action EW:** Prepare an announcement ready for October
 - **Action completed**
- **Pinging for EDI?**
 - Poll in committee chat to decide on whether to ping or not
 - Also should do the announcements on instagram and whatsapp

10 Committee Suggestions (*standing item*) All

11 Any Other Business (*standing item*) All

- **Minecraft Server**
 - TK says server is going well
 - DJ says they have updated the modpack to include some new suggested mods (including some for moderation)
- **Tex bot changes**
 - **Action JS:** Organise discussion outside meeting and plan the potential changes
 - **Action in progress**
- **Nav Bar Rework**
 - Fresher's logo has been updated by AW
 - JA asks for feedback to the changes
 - AW asks when to take the fresher's week page off the website
 - This weekend is suggested as the calendar then becomes useless
- **Newsletter**
 - **Action JA:** Write a newsletter
 - HT says this is needed as we have sponsors to whom we promised newsletter space
- **Future meetings**
 - Monday 14:00-15:00 currently
- **WhatsApp channels**
 - JA has made multiple different channels to allow users to talk to other people in their own group of the uni.
 - GT says he was worried as the whatsapp was until then just an announcement place.

- Moderation - GT has set some channels to request to join, and there will be issues and it will be a learning curve.
- We can make decisions as we go if there are multiple issues
- **Membership adverts**
 - TK suggests advertising needing memberships for the new events rather than saying we don't need them
 - JA says it was a good thing to bring up, as it is important to get more memberships.
 - TK suggests checking memberships for pizza
 - JA says that would discourage people from coming to events as it might be too expensive
 - JA says we try and keep the events as open as possible
 - HT needs to check names and memberships at the EGM

Actual start time	17:09 BST
Actual end time	18:51 BST
Duration	1 Hours 42 Minutes